

Full Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form

In developmental science, as in other scientific disciplines, professional integrity includes a commitment to an objective, unbiased presentation of facts and their interpretation. Authors' interests have the potential to influence how their work is presented and how it is received by readers. Often, the perception of a possible conflict of interest is as important as an actual conflict, and therefore any potential conflict must be disclosed, even if the author concludes that there is no actual conflict. Conflicts of interest are not limited to direct financial or other economic relationships with other entities. Various types of conflicts include:

- *Direct influence on the scholarship itself;*
- *Indirect influence on the scholarship, such as through family, business or personal relationships, or similar arrangements influencing a person without directly focusing on the specific work;*
- *Financial influence, such as compensation for any task related to the scholarship, employment-related compensation from an entity with a financial interest in the topic of the scholarship, or any profit from stock or intellectual property impacted by the subject of the scholarship;*
- *Non-financial influence from a third-party, such as support or assistance during the research or writing process, or professional advancement based on the outcome of research; and/or*
- *Other non-financial sources of conflict or bias, such as personal or political beliefs in direct conflict with the topic being researched, or a familial relationship with a person at an entity or enterprise that stands to benefit from or be harmed by the research.*

Although potential conflicts of interest do not necessarily constitute actual conflicts of interest, scientific integrity requires disclosure of all affiliations and interests, allowing editors and readers to judge and, if necessary, consider the impact of bias on the scientific information being shared.

1. MANUSCRIPT TITLE, NUMBER, AND JOURNAL:

Young Children ' s Spontaneous Comprehension of Symbol-Referent Relationships in the Graphic Domain.
CD MS CHILDDDEV-2025-1273; Child Development

2. AUTHOR NAME:

3. DATE:

March 24th, 2026

4. DIRECT CONFLICTS OF INTEREST:

Please list all sources of third party payments, in-kind benefits, or services provided at any time (or promised) for any part of the work submitted. This includes, but is not limited to, grants, personal fees or other income (for example, stock ownership, speaking fees, or consulting fees), and non-financial support (such as travel, writing assistance, or administrative support). Please list all entities, programs, and interests that could be perceived as benefiting financially or tangibly from the publication of this work, and the author's relationship(s) to those entities. Please include compensation or services from foundations, government agencies, commercial enterprises, etc. to you, your employer/organization, and/or your immediate family members. **This section should remain blank only if all work related to your submission was supported solely by you or funds from your institution, without any compensation (direct or indirect) from any other third-party to support your work.**

Full Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form (continued)

The first author, Gregor Kachel, was supported by the German Research Foundation (Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft) under project number 429220405.

5. OTHER FINANCIAL ACTIVITIES:

Please list other financial relationships that you and/or immediate family members have had over the last three years regarding the subject matter or research being published in this manuscript. "Financial relationships" includes any of the types of fees referenced in Question 4 that are not provided directly in support of the submitted work. This response should include any entity that can be considered broadly relevant to (or directly or indirectly referenced in) the research or study discussed in or related to this manuscript. Please include sources of financial support or in-kind support to conduct this research or any tasks related to it, such as speaking fees, consulting, or expert testimony. Please include any entities that could be perceived to benefit from or be harmed by publication of the work.

None to declare.

6. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY:

Please list all intellectual property in which you have an interest that is relevant to the submitted manuscript or related research. This includes copyrights, trademarks, patents awarded, patent applications under review, and patents planned but not yet filed.

None to declare.

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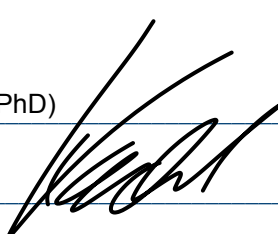
No potential conflicts of interest were identified.



I certify that this form is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge.

NAME: Gregor Kachel (PhD)

DATE: March 24th, 2026

SIGNATURE: 

OR

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CD MAG JOURNAL, 2025, 1070, CHILD DEVELOPMENT

2. AUTHOR NAME:

Prof. Dr. Daniel Haun

3. DATE:

March 24th, 2026

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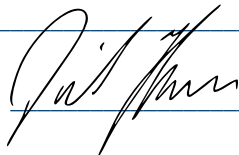
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I certify that this form is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge.

NAME: Prof. Dr. Manuel Bohn DATE: March 24th, 2026

SIGNATURE: _____

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